



FOSS Bytes

Google starts selling Nexus One, not in India though

Taking on rival Apple's iPhone, Internet search giant Google has launched its own smartphone, which according to the company, "belongs in the emerging class of devices" that it calls 'superphones'. The Google Nexus One combines the latest in hardware from HTC Corporation with the newest Android software (Android 2.1).

Manufactured by HTC of Taiwan, the Nexus One features noise suppression from Audience, Inc, a 9.4 cm (3.7inch) AMOLED 480 x 800 pixel WVGA display (a larger screen than Apple's iPhone) and a 1GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon chipset for blazing speeds. Weighing only 130 grams, the phone also includes a 5 MP camera with auto focus, a flash and geo tagging; onboard memory of 512 MB Flash, 512MB RAM and a 4GB MicroSD Card (expandable to 32 GB); 3.5-mm stereo headphone jack and 1400 mAh battery. The trackball doubles as a



notification tool, which contains a multi-colour LED for indicating incoming calls and other notifications.

Running on Android 2.1, the 'superphone' includes a voice-enabled keyboard so you can speak into any text field, fun Live Wallpapers, a 3D photo gallery for richer media experiences and lots more. Of course, it also comes with a host of Google applications, including Gmail, Google Voice and Google Maps Navigation.

The Nexus One is initially available from the Google Web store in the US—\$529 for an unlocked phone, or starting at \$179 with a two-year contract from T-Mobile USA. In the near future, Verizon Wireless in the US and Vodafone in Europe plan to offer services to customers in their respective geographies.

MSI to ship SUSE Moblin-powered netbook

MSI and Novell have announced that SUSE Moblin preloaded on the MSI U135 netbook will be launched some time in February 2010. Following the recent release of Moblin version 2.1, this marks the first OEM to sell a fully-supported netbook, with the Intel Atom processor running Moblin-based technology. The netbook offers a rich Internet experience with integrated e-mail, multimedia and Web browsing capabilities. The U135 netbook claims to offer 'nearly all-day computing capabilities' with long battery life and low power consumption. For more information on SUSE Moblin, visit www.novell.com/moblin.



World's first Snapdragon smartbook to run Android

Qualcomm has announced it is working with HP to design an Android-based smartbook device. The design utilises Qualcomm's Snapdragon QSD8250 chipset platform with an integrated Scorpion CPU, delivering speeds up to 1 GHz. The device demonstrates how long battery life, 3G and Wi-Fi connectivity, a highly intuitive user interface and other features can meet the consumer's need for a mobile, yet constantly connected lifestyle. HP demonstrated the device at the 2010 Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas.

Qualcomm's Snapdragon platform claims to offer an unprecedented combination of gigahertz mobile processing performance, optimised power consumption, ubiquitous connectivity and powerful multimedia, all on a single chip.

Linux Foundation starts online jobs board

The demand for Linux professionals has grown manifold since 2005. To cater to the rising demand for Linux-related jobs, the Linux Foundation (LF) has come up with its new Linux Jobs Board (<https://jobs.linux.com>). This will provide employers and job seekers with an online forum in which anyone can find the best and brightest Linux talent or the ideal job opportunity.

Employers interested in posting a job opening have two options: they can post their openings on Linux.com for \$100 for 15 days or \$200 for 30 days and reach millions of Linux-focused professionals, or pay additional fees to post jobs on the JobThread Network on Linux.com to reach 50 niche publishing sites with a combined 9.8 million visitors every month, reports LinuxDevices.com.

EU set to clear Oracle-Sun deal

MySQL founder Michael Widenius is taking his vocal campaign against Oracle's planned takeover of Sun Microsystems to China and Russia because the European Commission appears set to clear the deal, reports Reuters. The MySQL open source database is owned, developed and supported by Sun. The Commission was initially concerned that Oracle's takeover of the MySQL database could hurt competition in that market. However, Oracle recently said it would continue to enhance MySQL and would release future versions under an open source licence. The EC is likely to clear the deal by January 27, 2010.